

Travel Policy

Policy number: POL-TRV-002 **Owner:** Elena Petrova, Controller **Approved by:** Daniel Reyes, CFO
Effective date: 1 April 2026 (replaces POL-TRV-001)

1. Purpose

This policy explains how Northwind Labs employees plan, book and claim business travel. It aims to keep travellers safe and comfortable while spending company money as carefully as we would spend our own. It applies to every employee, contractor and intern travelling on Northwind business, whether they are based in Lisbon, Berlin, Austin, Kraków or work remotely.

2. Scope

Business travel covers customer visits, conferences, offsites, recruiting events and travel between Northwind offices. Commuting between your home and your usual office is not business travel and cannot be claimed.

3. Principles

- Travel only when a video call will not do the job. Internal meetings should default to Google Meet.
- Book the most economical option that is reasonable for the length and purpose of the trip.
- Book through the company travel portal (Navan) so that the Travel Desk can locate you in an emergency.
- Keep receipts for every expense above \$25 (or €25 / 100 PLN) and submit them in Expensify.

4. Pre-trip approval

All trips need approval from your direct manager before anything is booked. The approval is recorded automatically when you submit a trip request in Navan.

Trip type	Approver
Domestic trip, up to 3 nights	Direct manager
International trip within Europe or within North America	Direct manager
Intercontinental trip	Direct manager and department VP
Any trip with total estimated cost above \$6,000	Department VP and Controller

Trips booked outside Navan without a documented reason (for example, the portal had no availability) may not be reimbursed.

5. Booking air travel

5.1 Advance booking

Flights should be booked at least **14 days before departure**. Bookings made later than that need a one-line justification in the Navan request (for example, an urgent customer escalation). Repeated late bookings are reviewed by Finance each quarter.

5.2 Class of travel

Scheduled flight time (single leg)	Allowed cabin
Under 6 hours	Economy
6 to 9 hours	Premium economy
Over 9 hours	Business class with VP approval, otherwise premium economy

Flight time is the scheduled time of the longest single leg, not the total journey including layovers.

5.3 Fares and extras

- Choose the lowest logical fare within a two-hour window around your preferred departure time.
- One checked bag is reimbursable on trips of three nights or longer, or when you carry demo hardware.
- Seat selection fees up to \$40 per leg are reimbursable.
- Airline lounge memberships, in-flight Wi-Fi for personal use and upgrades bought with cash are not reimbursable.

6. Rail and ground transport

Rail is the preferred option for journeys under four hours, for example Berlin to Hamburg or Lisbon to Porto. Second class is the standard; first class is allowed when the first-class fare is no more than 20% higher than second class.

Taxis and ride-hailing (Uber, Bolt, FreeNow) are fine for trips to and from airports and customer sites. Public transport is encouraged where it is safe and practical. Rental cars require manager approval and must be the compact category unless four or more colleagues are travelling together. Mileage for a personal car is reimbursed at the local statutory rate.

7. Accommodation

Book hotels through Navan. Stay at a hotel close to the customer site or event venue, in a standard room. Airbnb and similar rentals are allowed for stays of five nights or more, or for team offsites, when they are cheaper than the equivalent hotel rooms.

7.1 Nightly hotel caps

The caps below are per night, before local taxes. If the event you are attending pushes prices above the cap, ask the Travel Desk (travel@northwind.example) before booking.

City	Nightly cap
Lisbon	€160
Berlin	€170
Kraków	650 PLN
London	£220
Paris	€210
Austin	\$230
New York City	\$340
San Francisco	\$320
Any other city	\$180 or local equivalent

Employees travelling to a city where Northwind has an office must not book a hotel if they live within 50 km of that office.

8. Per diem in the United States

Instead of collecting receipts for every meal, travellers receive a flat daily per diem that covers breakfast, lunch, dinner, snacks and tips. Per diems are paid through Expensify when you submit your trip report.

Location	Daily per diem
United States (all cities)	\$75 per day
Canada	CAD 95 per day
Mexico	\$55 per day

The US per diem of \$75 per day applies to every US city, including Austin, New York and San Francisco. Travellers based in the Austin office do not receive a per diem when working in Austin.

On the first and last day of a trip you receive 75% of the daily rate. When a meal is provided by a customer, a conference or Northwind (for example, a team dinner), deduct 20% of the daily rate for that meal. Per diem amounts for other regions are listed in section 9.

9. Per diem by region (outside North America)

The per diem rules in section 8 (75% on travel days, 20% deduction for provided meals) apply to every region below. Rates are fixed in local currency so that travellers are not affected by exchange-rate movements.

Region	Daily per diem
Europe (EU, EEA, Switzerland, United Kingdom)	€65 per day
Poland, when travelling from another country	260 PLN per day
Middle East	\$70 per day
Asia-Pacific (Singapore, Japan, Australia)	\$80 per day
Asia-Pacific (other countries)	\$50 per day
Latin America	\$50 per day
Africa	\$50 per day

The Europe per diem of €65 per day applies to all European business trips, including trips between the Lisbon, Berlin and Kraków offices. Employees do not receive a per diem in the city where they are based.

9.1 Long trips

For trips longer than 14 consecutive nights in the same city, the per diem drops to 70% of the regional rate from night 15 onward, because travellers usually have access to a kitchen or longer-term accommodation.

Customer dinners are not part of the per diem; they are claimed as client meals under the Expense Policy (POL-FIN-001).

10. Travel safety

Northwind uses International SOS for travel risk monitoring. Before travelling to a country rated "high" or "extreme" risk, you need written approval from the Head of Security, Jonas Weber. Register every trip in Navan so that International SOS alerts can reach you. In an emergency call the International SOS hotline printed on the back of your Northwind badge.

Laptops must stay with you or in a locked hotel safe. Never check a company laptop into the aircraft hold.

11. Submitting your trip report

- 1. Within 30 days of returning, open Expensify and create a trip report linked to your Navan trip ID.
- 2. Add receipts for every item above \$25, plus all hotel folios regardless of amount.
- 3. Expensify calculates the per diem automatically from your travel dates and destination.
- 4. Your manager approves the report, then Finance reviews it. Reimbursement is paid with the next payroll run after Finance approval.

Reports submitted more than 90 days after the trip are rejected unless the Controller grants an exception.

12. Non-reimbursable items

Personal entertainment (movies, minibar, spa), travel insurance (the corporate policy already covers you), traffic or parking fines, costs for a travelling companion, and upgrades not covered in section 5.2.

13. Combining business and personal travel

You may extend a business trip for personal time ("bleisure") as long as the extension does not increase the airfare by more than \$150. Any hotel nights, meals and transport during the personal days are your own expense. Tell your manager about the extension when you submit the trip request.

14. Exceptions and violations

Exceptions to this policy must be approved in writing by the Controller before the expense is incurred. Expenses that break this policy are returned to the traveller for correction. Repeated or deliberate violations are escalated to the People team and may lead to disciplinary action.

15. Contacts

Topic	Contact
Booking help, Navan access	Travel Desk, travel@northwind.example, Slack #travel-desk
Expense reports and per diem questions	Finance Operations, Slack #ask-finance
Travel safety and high-risk countries	Jonas Weber, Head of Security
Policy exceptions	Elena Petrova, Controller

Revision history: POL-TRV-001 (2022) introduced Navan. POL-TRV-002 (2026) raised the US per diem, added the rail rule and the hotel caps table.